FR

Fee Reconciliation Desk

FEE PAYMENT MATCHING AND RECONCILIATION

USER GUIDE

User Guide

Screen-by-screen guide for Operations, counsellors, Finance, administrators and students

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Audience Operations executives, counsellors, Finance reviewers and approvers, administrators and students

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FRD-QS-03	Quick Start
FRD-FAQ-04	FAQ and Troubleshooting
FRD-TD-05	Technical Design
FRD-UAT-06	UAT Test Cases
FRD-RN-07	Release Notes v1.0

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1 About this guide

This guide covers every screen of Fee Reconciliation Desk in the order you meet them as a payment moves from the bank to a student's receipt. Most screens have a screenshot with numbered orange markers and a table that explains each marked item.

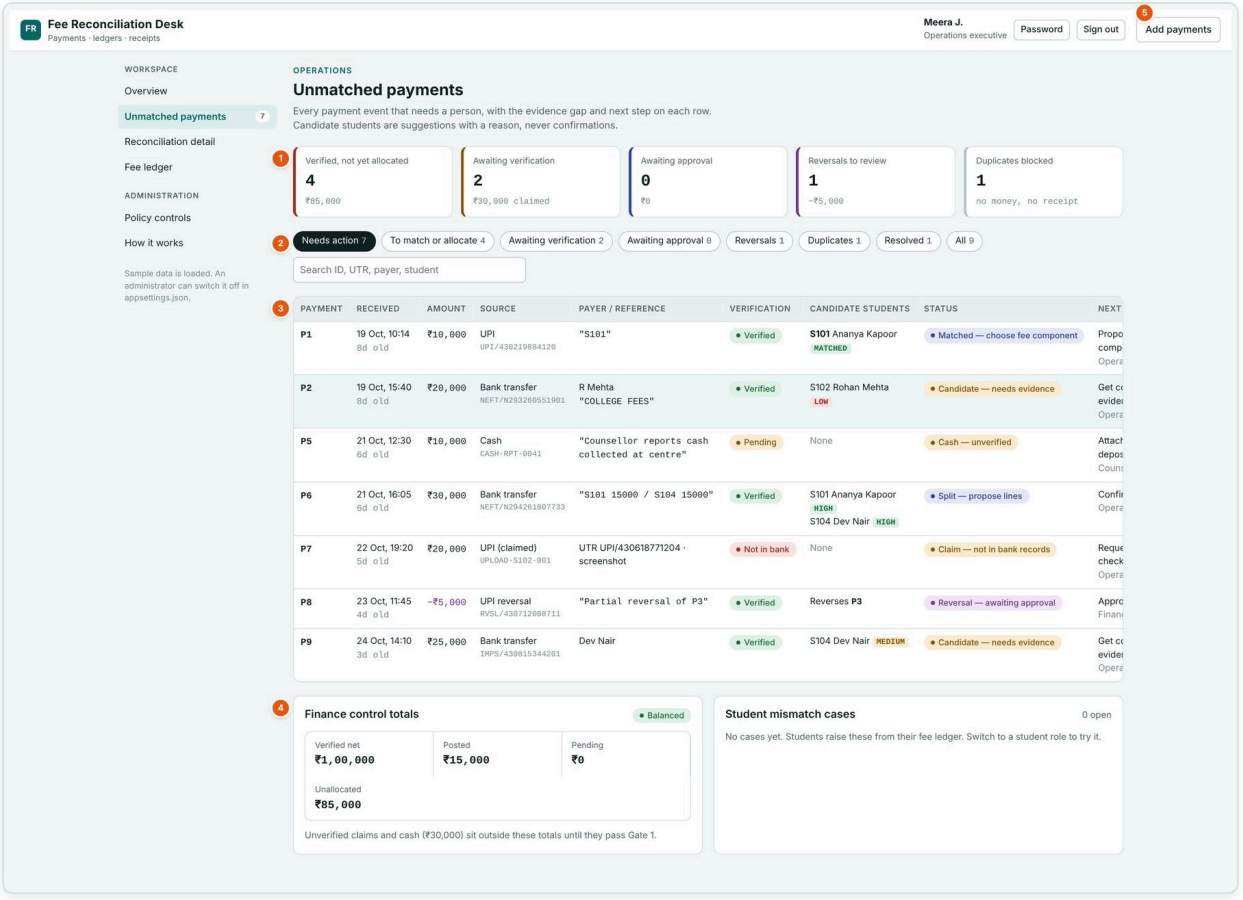


Figure 1: The Unmatched payments queue, where Operations starts each day

1.1 What Fee Reconciliation Desk does

Fee Reconciliation Desk matches every fee payment to the right student and fee component. A second person approves the match, then the payment is posted to the student's ledger once and one receipt is issued. It takes payments from four places:

- **Bank statement lines** that Finance imports from the college bank account (UPI, NEFT, IMPS and others).
- **Cash** collected by a counsellor at the desk and later deposited in the bank.
- **Student claims**: a student tells the college about a payment and gives the UTR, with an optional screenshot.
- **Bank reversals**: negative lines that take money back from an earlier payment.

For example, a ₹30,000 bank transfer with the remark `S101 15000 / S104 15000` becomes two allocation lines, one of ₹15,000 for each student. A Finance approver approves both lines together. Each student gets one receipt for their line, and the money is counted only once.

Three rules the application always follows

- **Only verified money counts.** A balance changes only for money confirmed in the bank statement, or cash that Finance has matched to a bank deposit. A screenshot or a counsellor's word is never proof.
- **Two people for every decision about money.** Whoever proposes an allocation, requests a correction or reports cash can never approve or verify it, even if they hold a Finance role.
- **Nothing is deleted.** Duplicates are kept but never counted. Reversals and corrections are separate linked entries. Receipts are adjusted or cancelled, never edited away.

1.2 Who should read it

Reader	Sections to read
Operations executives	All sections
Counsellors	2, 3, 8 and 13
Finance reviewers	2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 11 and 13
Finance approvers	2 to 7, 11 and 13
Administrators	2, 3, 11, 12 and 13. Also the Installation and Administration Guide (FRD-IG-02).
Students	2 and 10

1.3 How to read the screenshots

The screenshots come from the sample data that ships with the application: four students (S101 Ananya Kapoor, S102 Rohan Mehta, S103 Zara Ali and S104 Dev Nair) and nine payments (P1 to P9). The orange numbered circles are not part of the application. They point to the items explained in the table under each figure.

1.4 Key terms

Term	Meaning
Payment	One money event: a bank line, a cash report, a student claim or a reversal. Each has an ID such as P6.
UTR / transaction ID	The bank's unique reference for a payment, such as `UPI/430219884120`
Verified	Confirmed in the bank statement, or cash matched to a bank deposit by Finance
Candidate	A student who might own a payment, with a reason and a confidence level (High, Medium or Low)
Fee component	The fee a payment pays for: Admission (₹25,000) or Tuition (₹1,20,000) in the sample data
Allocation line	One student, one fee component and one amount. A payment can have several lines.
Proposal	A set of allocation lines waiting for a Finance approver
Posted	Written to the student's fee ledger. Only posted money reduces what a student owes.

Term	Meaning
Receipt	Issued once for each posted line. Reversals adjust it and corrections cancel it.
Control difference	Verified money minus (posted + awaiting approval + unallocated). It must always be ₹0.

2 Getting started

2.1 Opening the application and signing in

1. Open the address your administrator gave you. On a single laptop this is http://localhost:5090.
2. Enter your user name and password, and click **Sign in**.

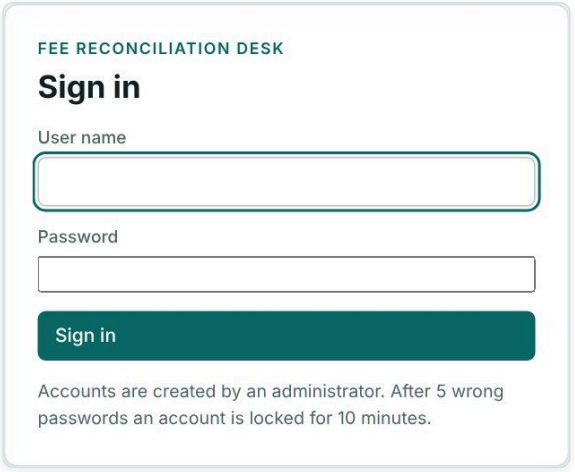


Figure 2: The sign-in card

After 5 wrong passwords, your account is locked for 10 minutes. The message is the same whether the user name or the password is wrong, so the screen never reveals which user names exist.

2.2 Screen layout

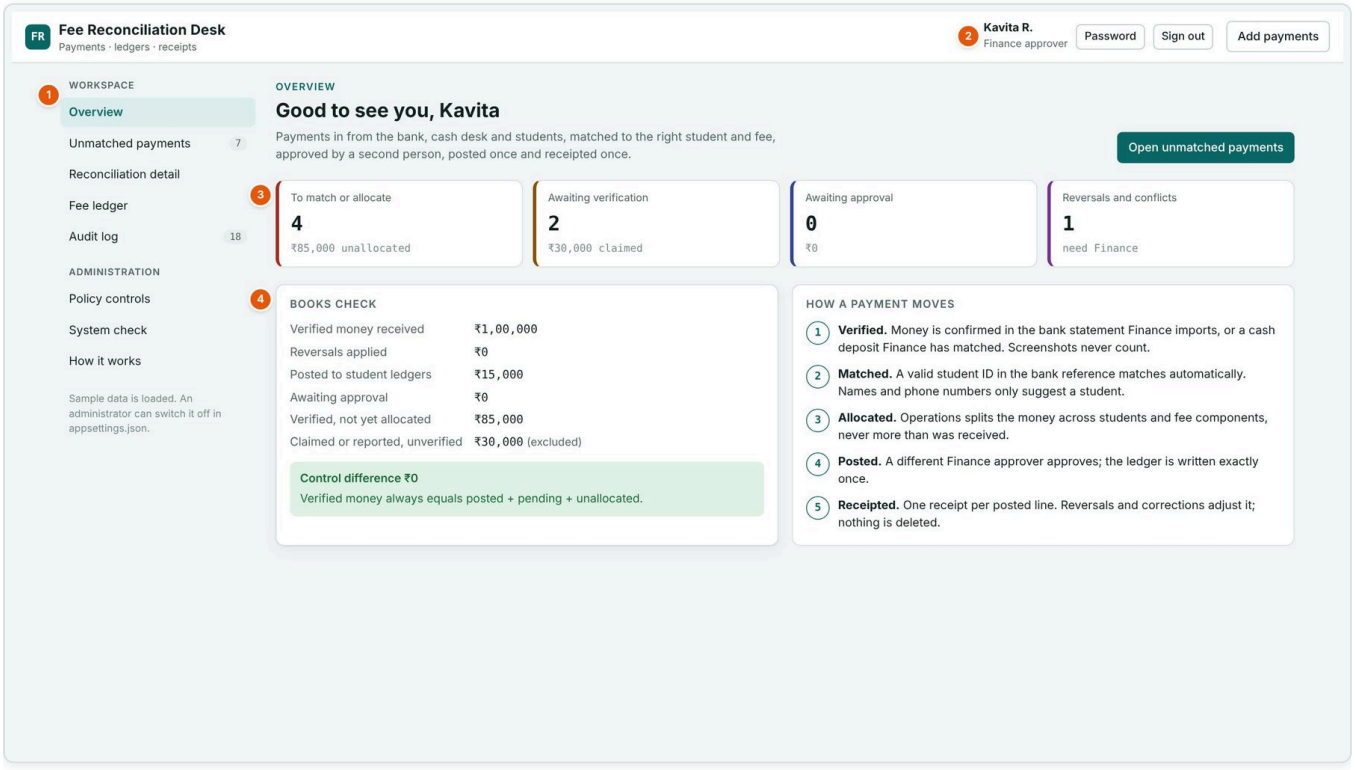


Figure 3: The Overview page for a Finance approver

#	Item	What it does
1	Side menu	The screens your role can open. A number shows how many items are waiting.
2	Signed-in person	Your name and role. **Password** changes your password, **Sign out** ends the session, and **Add payments** opens imports and cash reports.
3	Stage tiles	Payments to match or allocate, awaiting verification, awaiting approval, and reversals and conflicts. Click a tile to open the queue filtered to that stage.
4	Books check	Verified money broken down into posted, awaiting approval and not yet allocated, plus unverified claims shown separately. The green box confirms the control difference is ₹0.

2.3 Roles and what you can do

Role	What you do	What you cannot do
Operations executive	Work the queue, propose allocations, request evidence, escalate, request corrections, resolve student cases, report cash	Approve, import bank statements, verify cash
Counsellor	Report cash collected at the desk, attach receipt-book and deposit-slip evidence	Allocate, approve, verify cash
Finance reviewer	Import bank statements, verify cash, close bank-data conflicts, propose allocations, read the audit log, export	Approve allocations, apply reversals
Finance approver	Everything a reviewer does, plus approve or reject allocations, apply reversals, approve corrections	Approve anything they proposed or requested themselves
Administrator	Users and roles, policy controls, audit log, system check, export	Propose, approve, post or correct money
Student	See their own fee ledger and receipts, report a payment, raise a mismatch case	See any other student, any college total or any staff data

2.4 Signing out and session timeout

Click **Sign out** at the top right. You are signed out automatically after 30 minutes without activity. Your session also ends if an administrator changes your role, disables your account or resets your password. Sign in again when that happens.

3 How a payment moves

Every payment passes five gates in order. A gate cannot be skipped, and each one has an owner.

Gate	Name	What must be true	Who acts
1	Verified	The money is in the imported bank statement, or Finance has matched a cash deposit to the bank statement and cashbook	Finance
2	Matched	The student is known. A valid student ID in the bank reference matches automatically; a name or phone number only suggests a candidate.	System, then Operations
3	Allocated	Lines name the student, fee component and amount. Their total can never exceed the money received minus reversals.	Operations proposes
4	Posted	A Finance approver who is not the proposer approves. The ledger is written exactly once, even if the posting is retried.	Finance approver
5	Receipted	One receipt per posted line. Reversals adjust it and corrections cancel it; the number never changes.	System

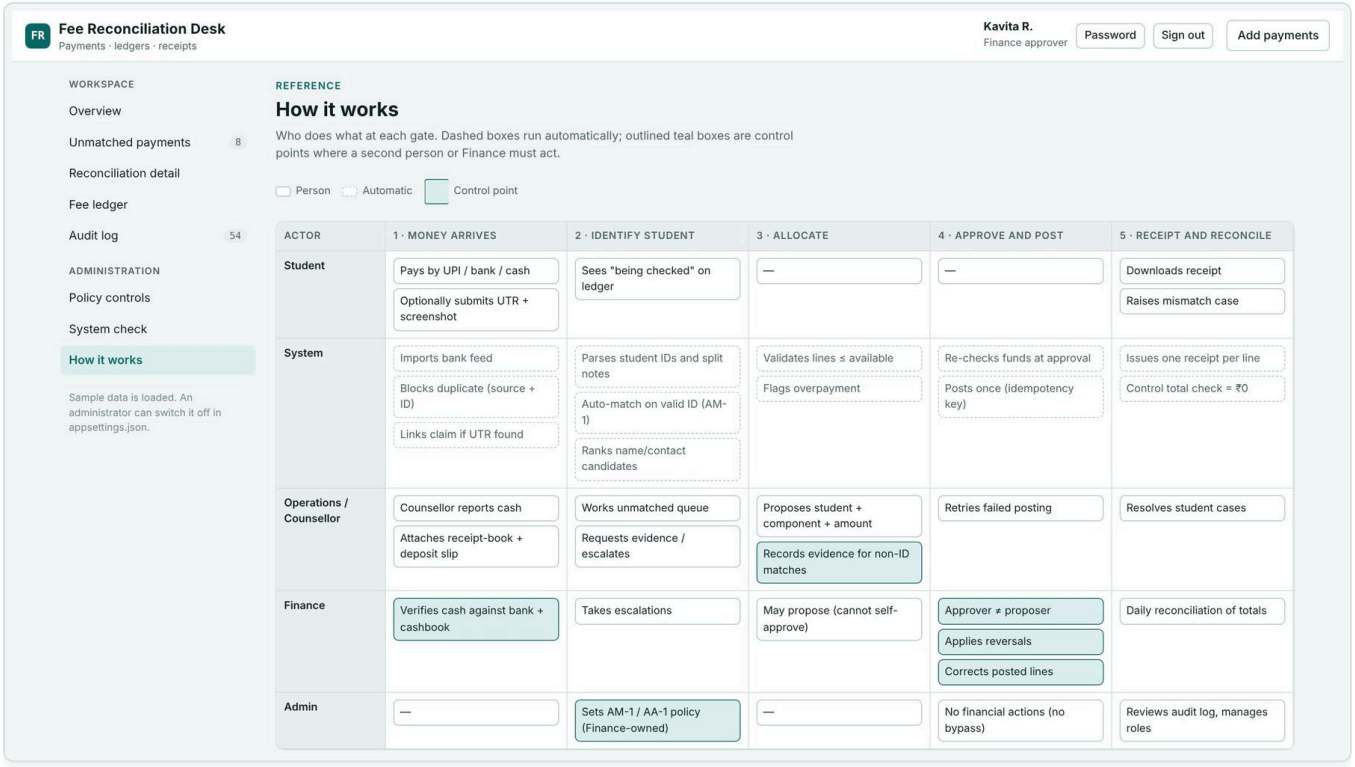


Figure 4: How it works, the same five gates shown inside the application

4 Unmatched payments queue

Unmatched payments lists every payment that needs a person.

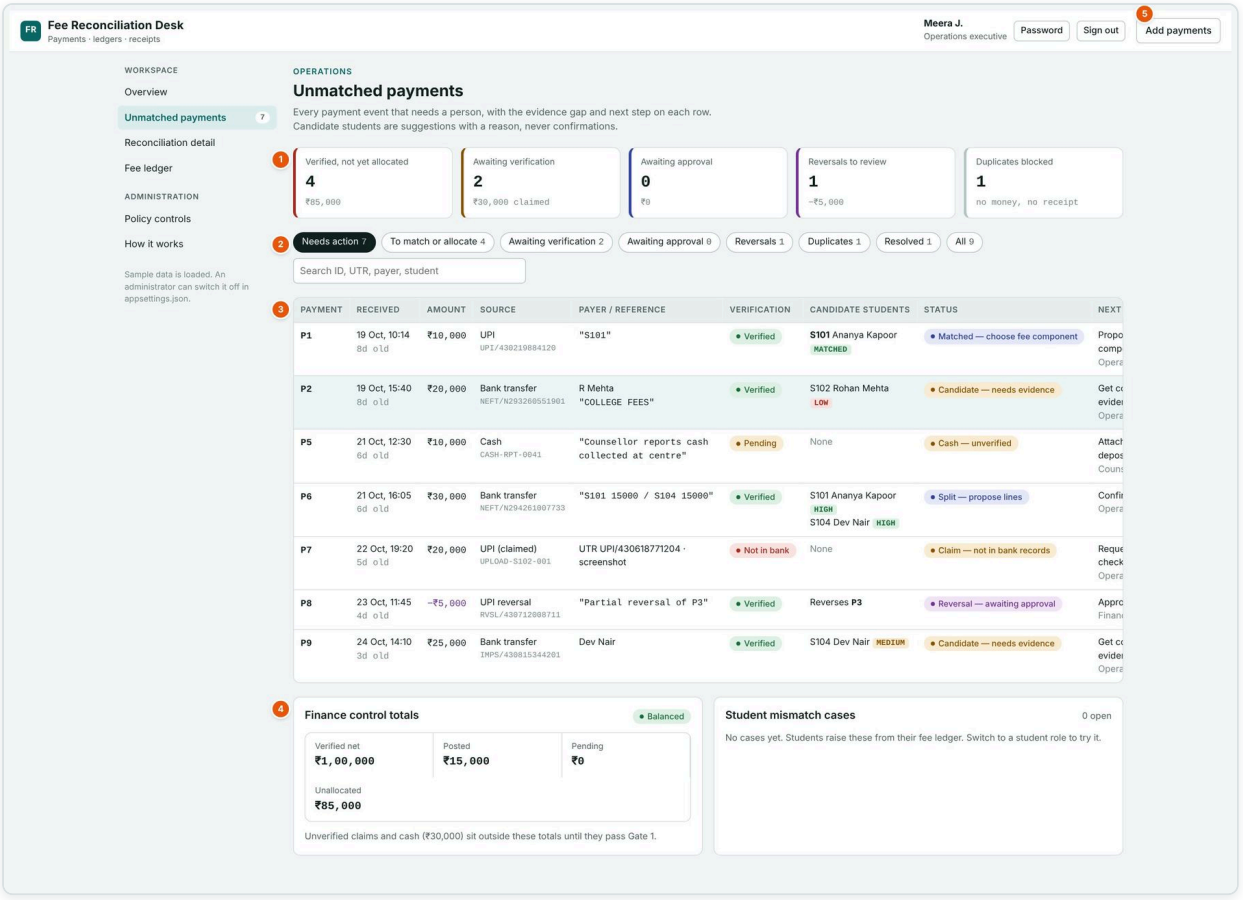


Figure 5: The queue for an Operations executive

#	Item	What it does
1	Stage tiles	How many payments, and how much money, sit at each stage. *Duplicates blocked* shows re-imported lines that carry no money and no receipt.
2	Filter chips and search	Narrow the list by stage, or search by payment ID, UTR, payer or student.
3	Payment table	One row per payment: received time and age, amount, source, payer and reference, verification, candidate students with confidence, status, and the next action with its owner. Click a row to open it.
4	Finance control totals and student cases	The live books check, and mismatch cases raised by students
5	Add payments	Import a bank statement (Finance), report cash (counsellors and Operations) or add a student (administrators)

Work the queue from the top

The *Next* column says what is missing and who owns the next step. Start with rows marked for your role, then the oldest.

5 Reconciliation detail: allocating a payment

Open a payment from the queue, or with **← P5** and **P7 →** at the top right of the detail page.

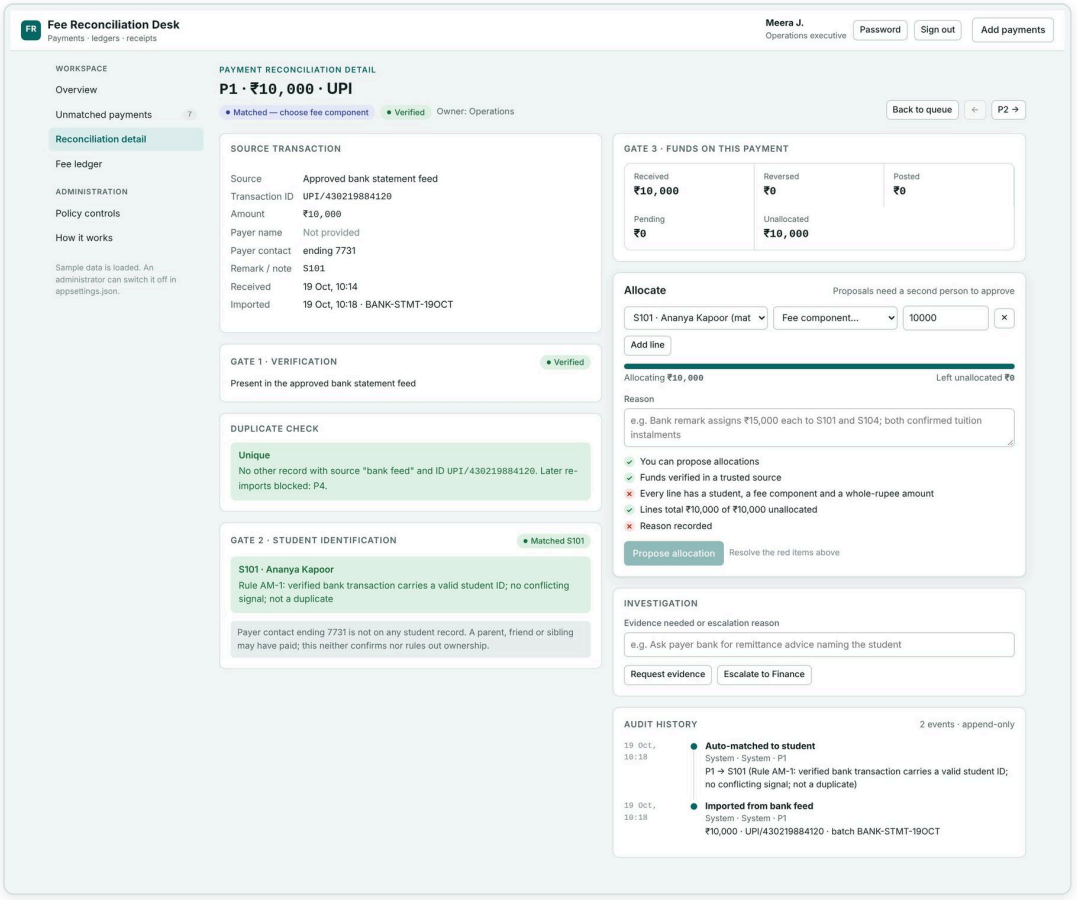


Figure 6: P1, matched on student ID S101, waiting for a fee component

The left column shows the evidence:

- **Source transaction**: the bank record exactly as it was imported.
- **Gate 1 · Verification**: whether the money is confirmed, and where.
- **Duplicate check**: whether another record has the same source and ID.
- **Gate 2 · Student identification**: candidate students with the reason and confidence for each.

The right column is where you act: the funds on this payment (received, reversed, posted, pending, unallocated), the **Allocate** editor, approval and posting, investigation, and the audit history.

5.1 Proposing an allocation

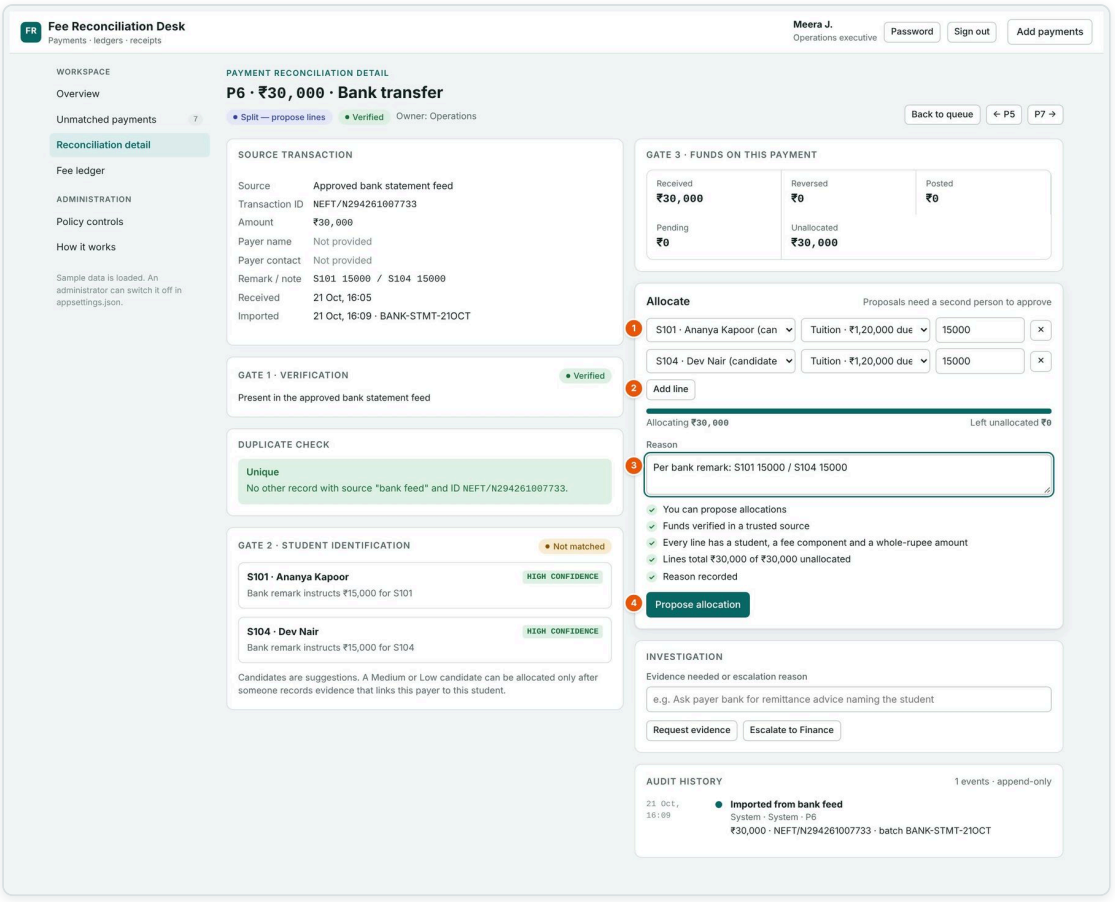


Figure 7: Allocating the P6 split across two students

#	Item	What it does
1	Allocation lines	Student, fee component (with the amount still outstanding) and amount. Split instructions in the bank remark are filled in for you.
2	Add line	Adds another student or fee component. The bar below shows how much is allocated and how much is left.
3	Reason	Required. Say why the money belongs to these students.
4	Propose allocation	Turns on only when every check above it is green. A Finance approver who is not you approves it.

1. Pick the student, the fee component and the amount on each line.
2. Write a reason.
3. If a student on a line has no verified identifier on this payment (a name or phone match only), a **Corroborating evidence** box appears and must be filled in. Say what proves the link, for example a remittance advice naming the student, or a guardian confirmation from the registered number.
4. Check the list: every line has a student, a component and a whole-rupee amount, the lines total no more than the unallocated money, and a reason is recorded.
5. Click **Propose allocation**. The payment shows *Awaiting approval*.

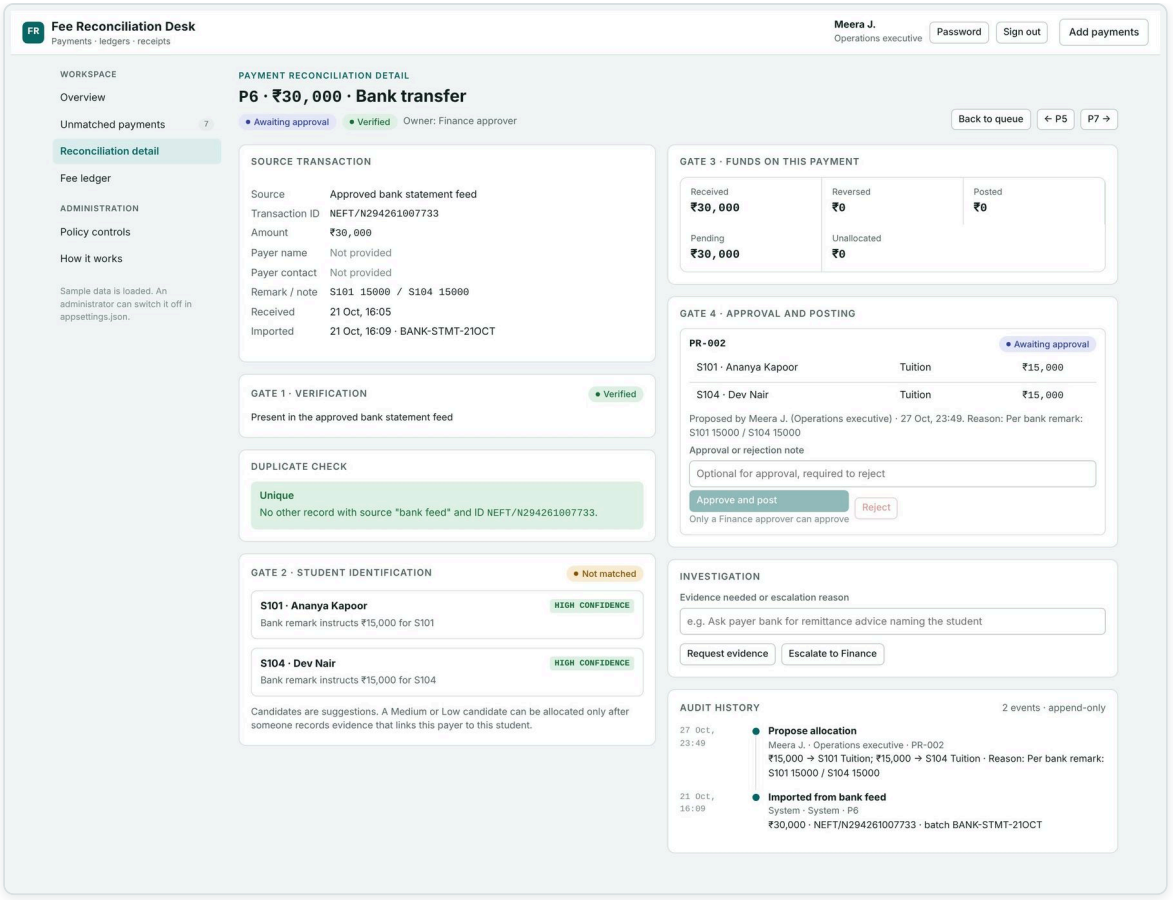


Figure 8: P6 after the proposal; Operations cannot approve it

5.2 When you cannot allocate yet

Button	When to use it	What happens
Request evidence	You need something from the payer, such as remittance advice	Your request is recorded; the payment shows *Waiting on payer*
Escalate to Finance	The case needs Finance, for example a disputed bank line	Ownership moves to a Finance reviewer
Retry student lookup	The student ID in the remark was not registered when the payment arrived	The ID is checked again; if it is now registered, the payment is matched
Re-check bank feed	A student claim's UTR is not in the bank records yet	The imported bank lines are searched again and the claim is linked if found

Why a matching name is not enough

Names are not unique and parents often share them. P9 comes from "Dev Nair" and student S104 is Dev Nair, but the payment carries no student ID. The application shows S104 as a *Medium* candidate and asks for evidence before anyone can allocate. A wrong allocation costs a correction, a refund conversation and the student's trust.

6 Approving and posting (Finance approvers)

Open a payment showing *Awaiting approval*.

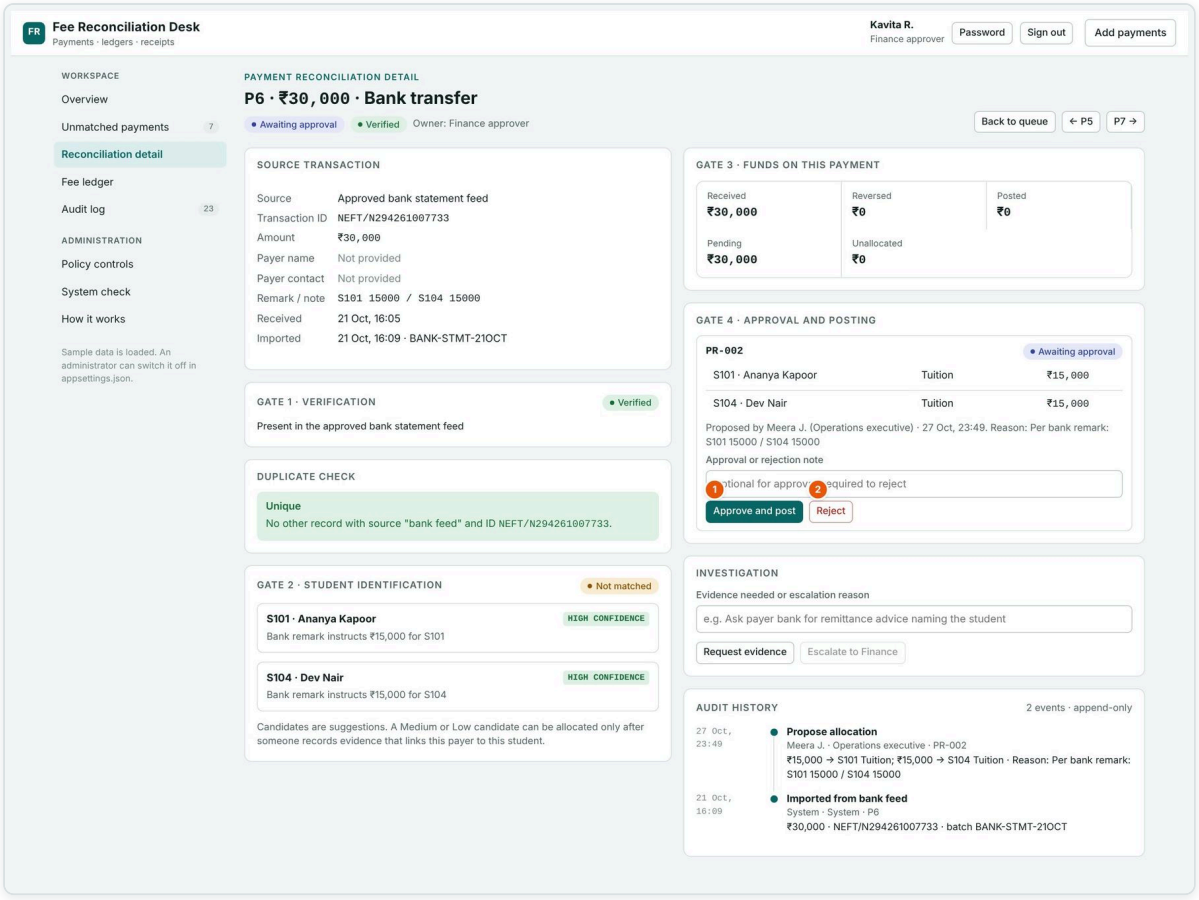


Figure 9: Gate 4, approving the P6 proposal

#	Item	What it does
1	Approve and post	Posts every line of the proposal together and issues one receipt per line
2	Reject	Sends the proposal back. A reason is required and the proposer sees it.

1. Read the lines, the reason and any evidence.
2. If a line is more than the fee still outstanding, write in **Approval note** how the overpayment is treated, for example as a credit to next term. The approval is refused without a note.
3. Click **Approve and post**, or **Reject** with a reason.

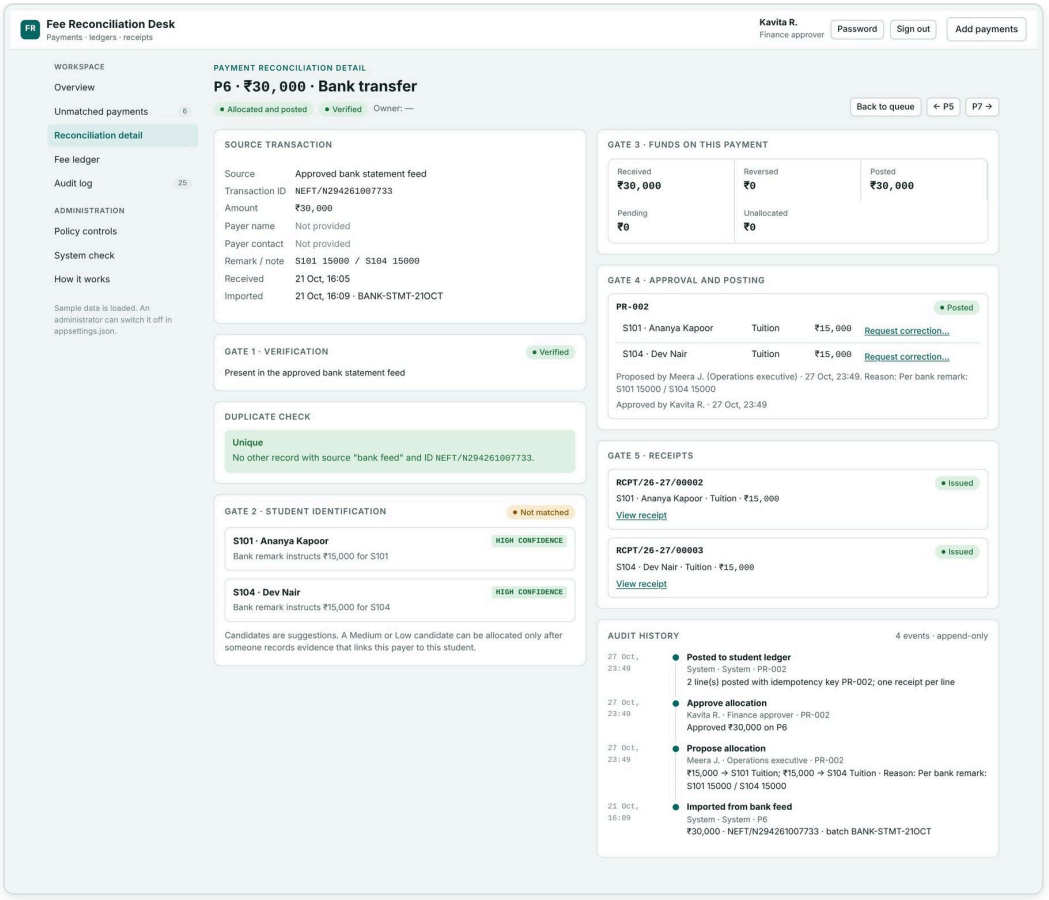


Figure 10: P6 posted: two ledger entries and two receipts

If you proposed the allocation yourself, **Approve and post** is disabled and the reason is shown under it. Ask another Finance approver.

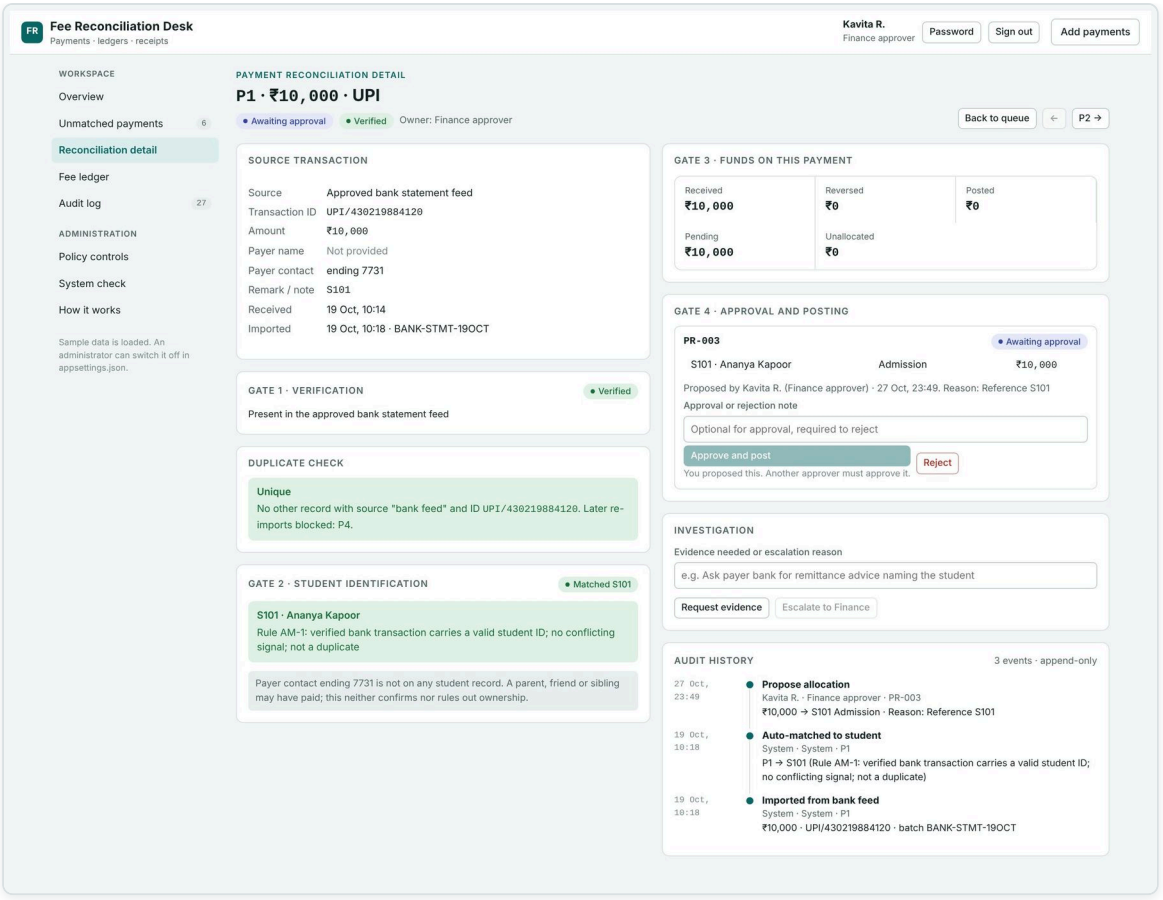


Figure 11: A Finance approver cannot approve her own proposal

Posting failed — retry

If the student-management system does not answer, nothing is written and the proposal shows *Posting failed — retry*. Click **Retry posting**. Every posting carries a unique key, so a retry can never post the same money twice.

7 Reversals and corrections

7.1 Applying a bank reversal (Finance approvers)

A negative bank line that names its original payment arrives as *Reversal — awaiting approval*. The **Reversal** panel shows the original payment, the reversal amount, what the original will net to once applied, and which posted line it comes off.

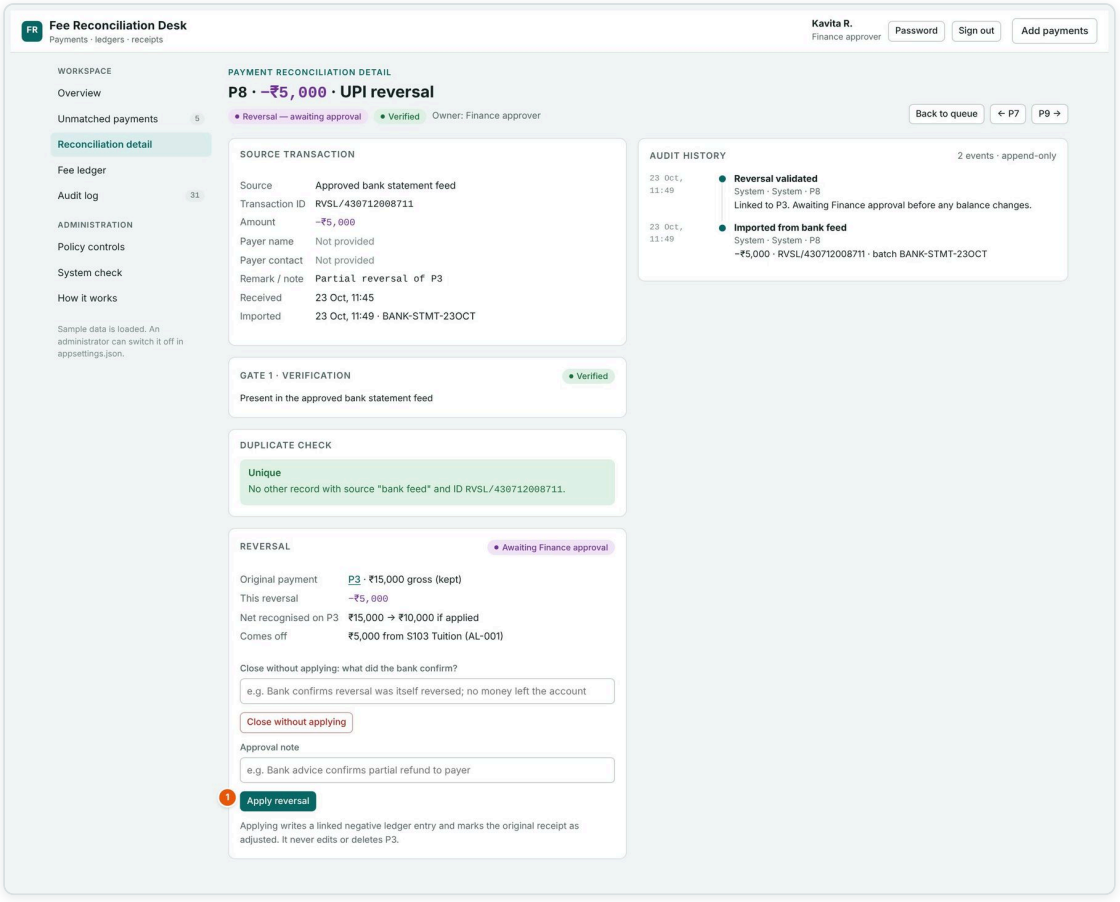


Figure 12: P8, a ₹5,000 partial reversal of P3

#	Item	What it does
1	Apply reversal	Writes a linked negative ledger entry and marks the original receipt *Adjusted*. The original payment keeps its full amount.

A reversal becomes a *Reversal exception* if it is larger than what is left on the original, or points to a duplicate or to cash. Confirm with the bank, then click **Re-check link to original** or **Close without applying** with a note of what the bank said.

7.2 Correcting a posted allocation

If money was posted to the wrong student or component:

1. **Operations** opens the payment and clicks **Request correction…** on the posted line, then gives the reason.

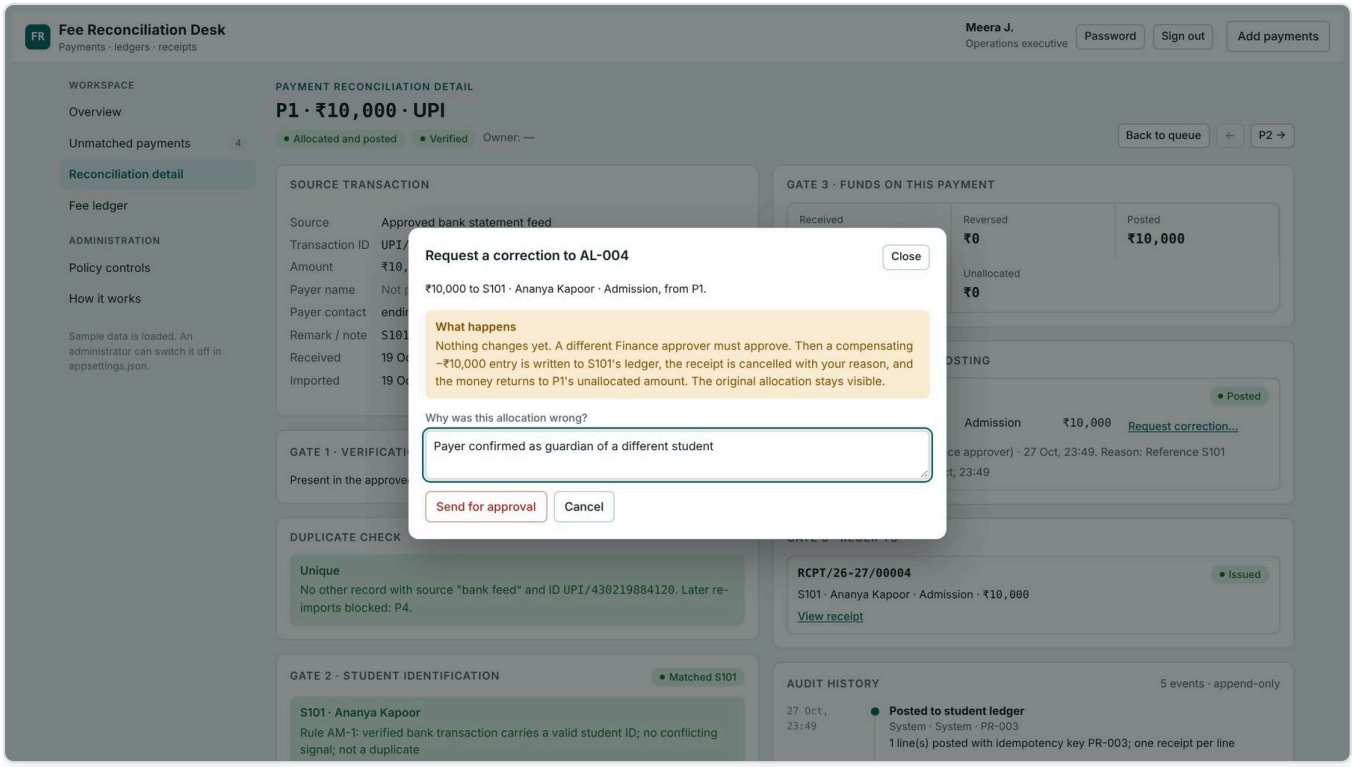


Figure 13: Requesting a correction on P1

2. **A Finance approver who did not request it** opens the payment and clicks **Approve correction** (or **Reject**).

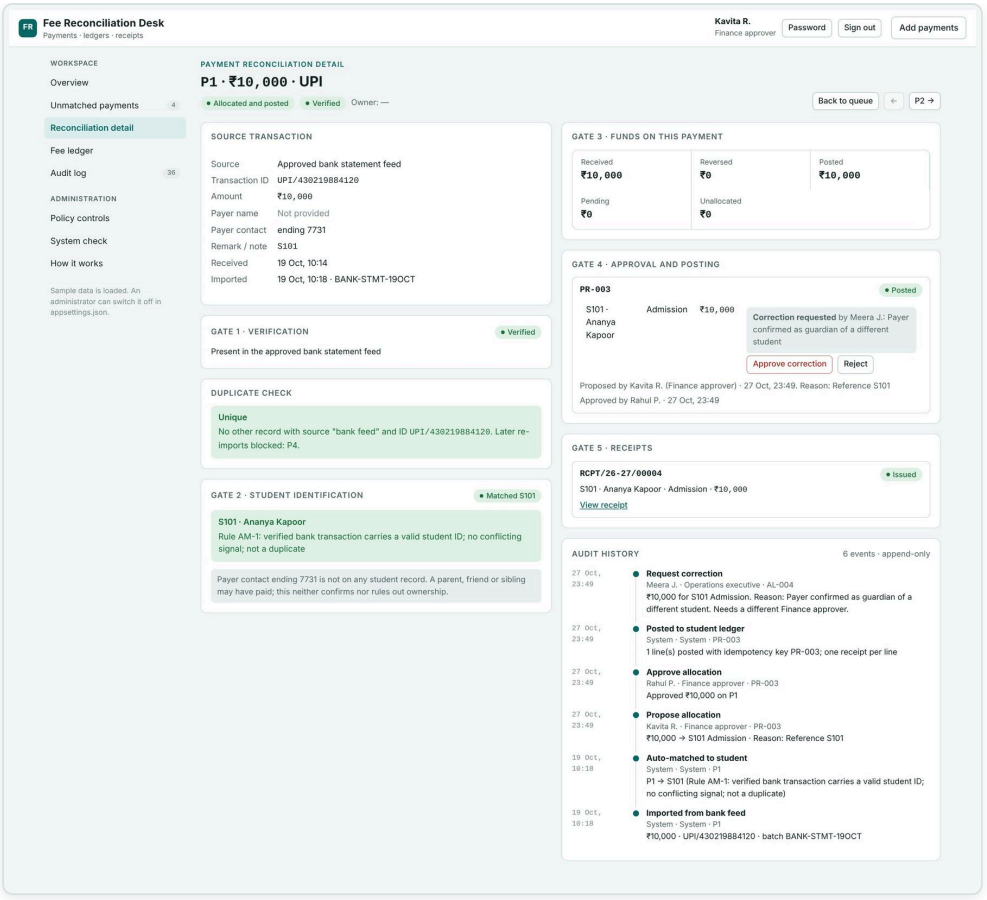


Figure 14: The correction waiting for a second person

The original line stays visible and a compensating entry is written. The receipt is cancelled with the reason, and the money returns to *unallocated* so it can be allocated again.

8 Adding payments

8.1 Importing a bank statement (Finance)

1. Click **Add payments** at the top right, then **Import bank statement**.
2. Choose the CSV exported from the college bank account and click **Import**.

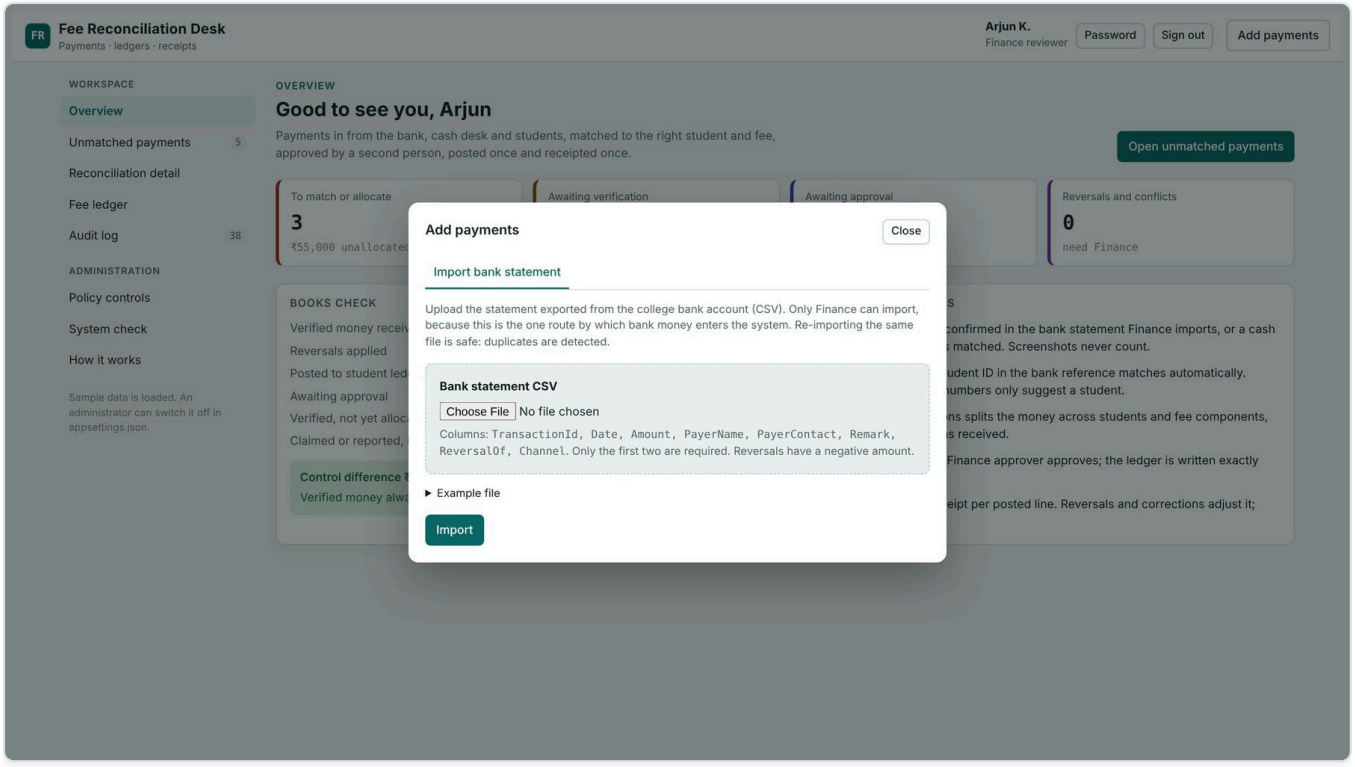


Figure 15: The bank statement import

The file must have `TransactionId` and `Amount` columns. `Date`, `Channel`, `PayerName`, `PayerContact`, `Remark` and `ReversalOf` are optional. Reversals carry a negative amount. The result line counts new payments, duplicates skipped, ID conflicts and rejected rows. Rows are rejected for a missing ID, text in the amount, zero, or more than ₹10 crore.

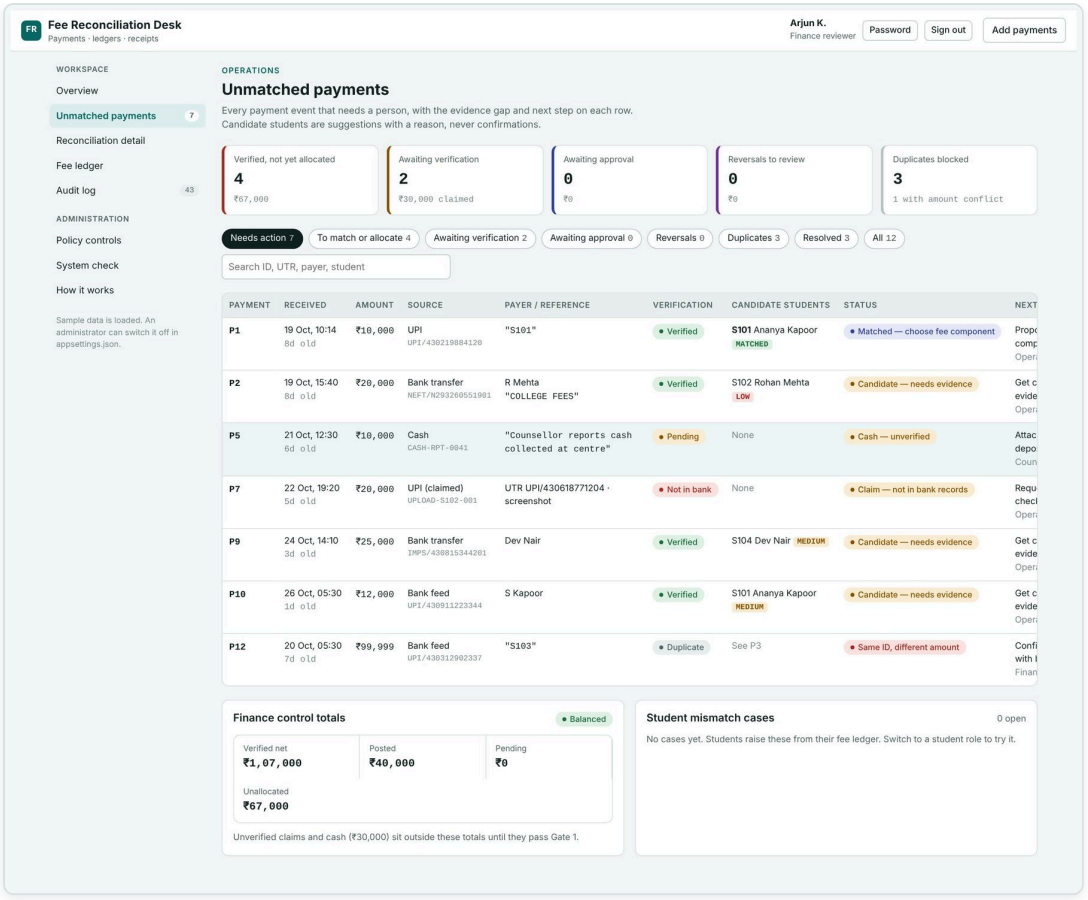


Figure 16: The queue after an import with a new payment, a duplicate and an ID conflict

Re-importing is safe

Duplicate detection ignores case, spaces and punctuation in the transaction ID, so importing the same file twice adds nothing. If a line repeats an existing ID with a **different** amount, it shows as *Same ID, different amount* and is never counted. Confirm the correct line with the bank and close it with **Keep … and close**.

8.2 Reporting cash (counsellors)

Cash stays out of every balance until Finance has matched it to a bank deposit.

1. Click **Add payments**, then **Report cash collection**. Enter the amount, the student and a note, and click **Record cash report**.

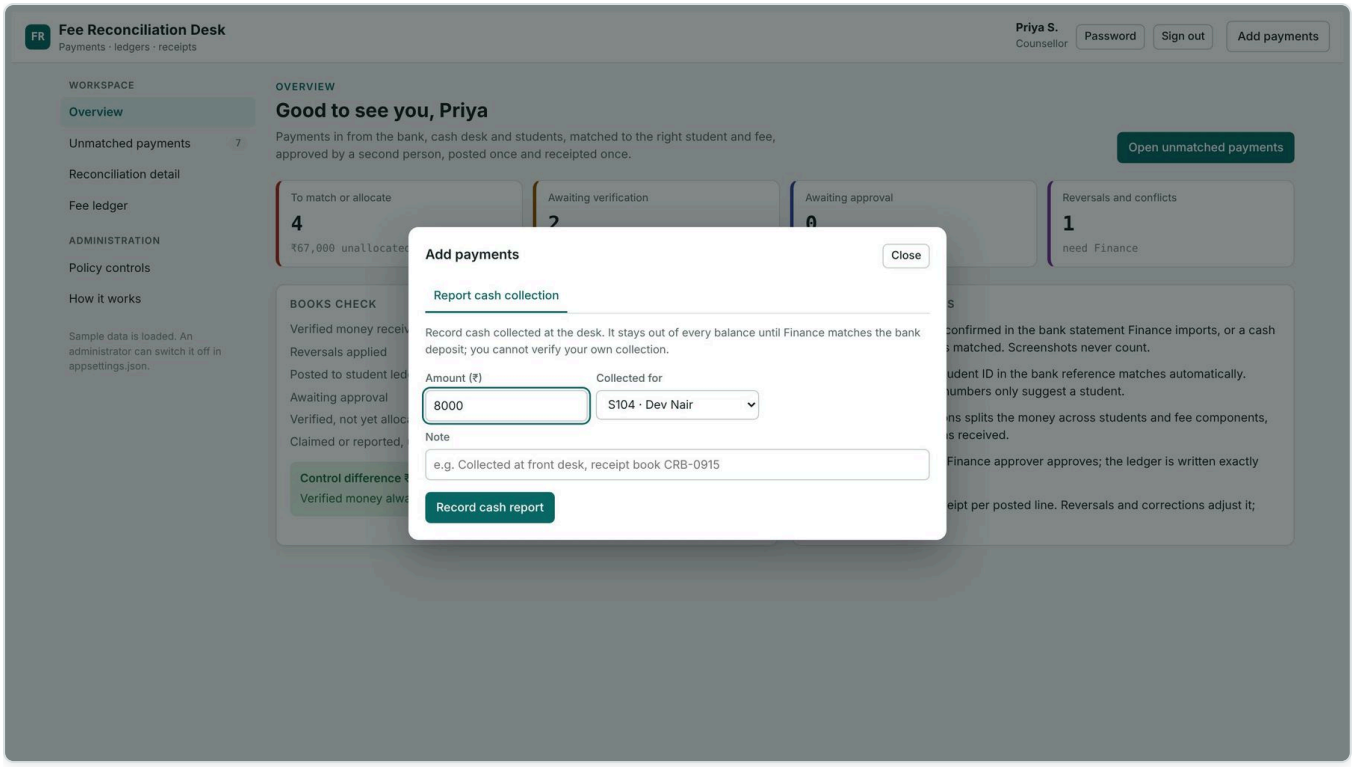


Figure 17: Reporting ₹8,000 collected for S104

2. On the cash record that opens, enter the evidence and click **Submit evidence to Finance**.

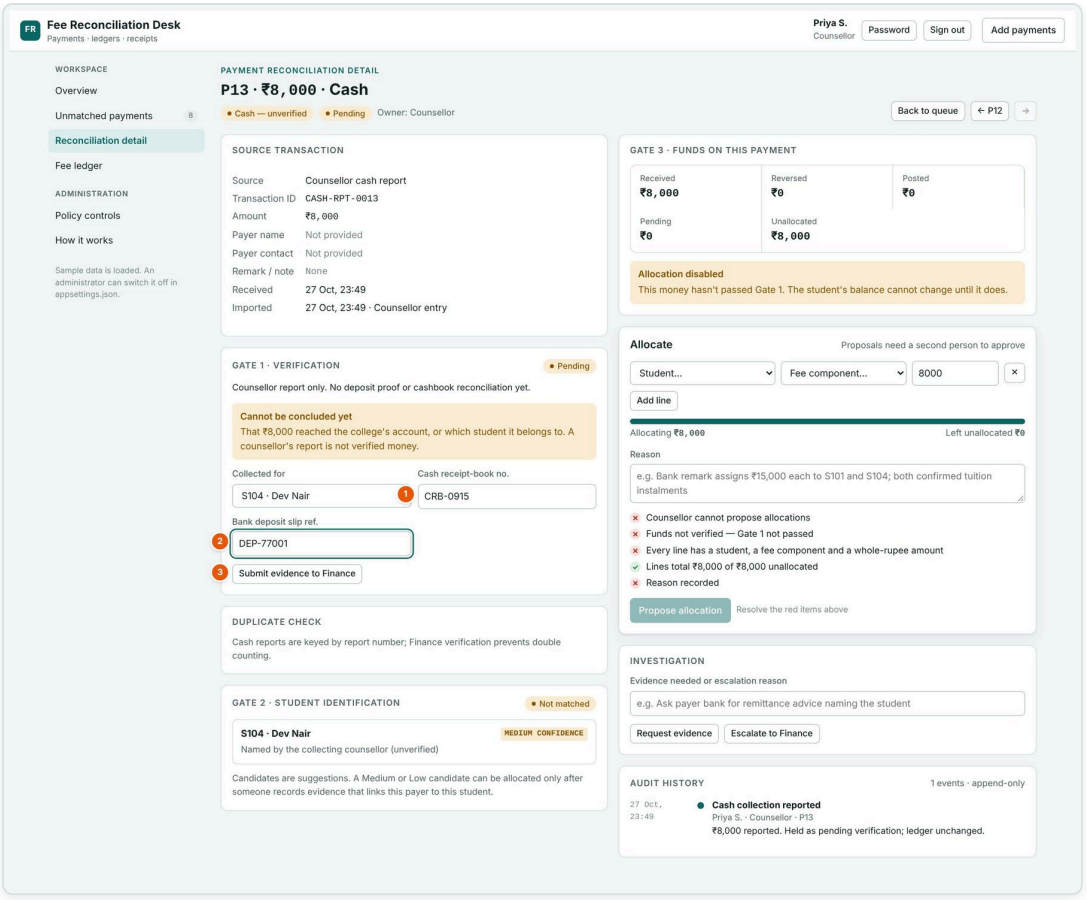


Figure 18: Attaching the cash evidence

#	Item	What it does
1	Cash receipt-book no.	The number on the paper receipt given to the student
2	Bank deposit slip ref.	The reference on the slip from depositing the cash
3	Submit evidence to Finance	Hands the record to Finance. Allocation stays disabled until the money is verified.

8.3 Verifying cash (Finance)

Open the cash record. Check the deposit slip against the bank statement and the cashbook, tick the confirmation and click **Verify deposit**. Whoever reported or evidenced the cash cannot verify it. Once verified, Operations allocates it like any other payment.

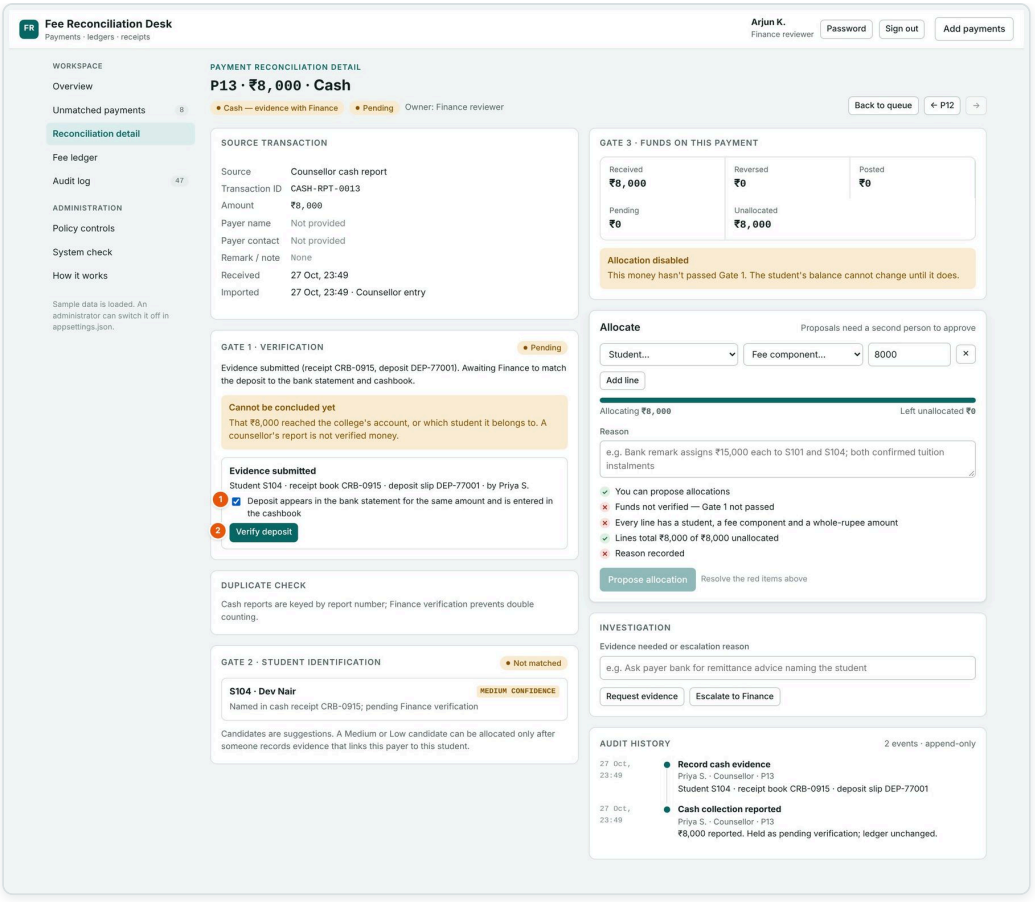


Figure 19: Finance verifies the deposit

#	Item	What it does
1	Confirmation	You confirm you matched the deposit slip to the bank statement and cashbook
2	Verify deposit	Marks the cash verified (gate 1) so it can be allocated

9 Student mismatch cases (Operations)

Open cases from students appear under the queue, in **Student mismatch cases**. Read the case, type the reply the student will see and click **Resolve**. The reply appears under **My cases** in the student's ledger.

10 For students: your fee ledger

Sign in to see **My fee ledger**.

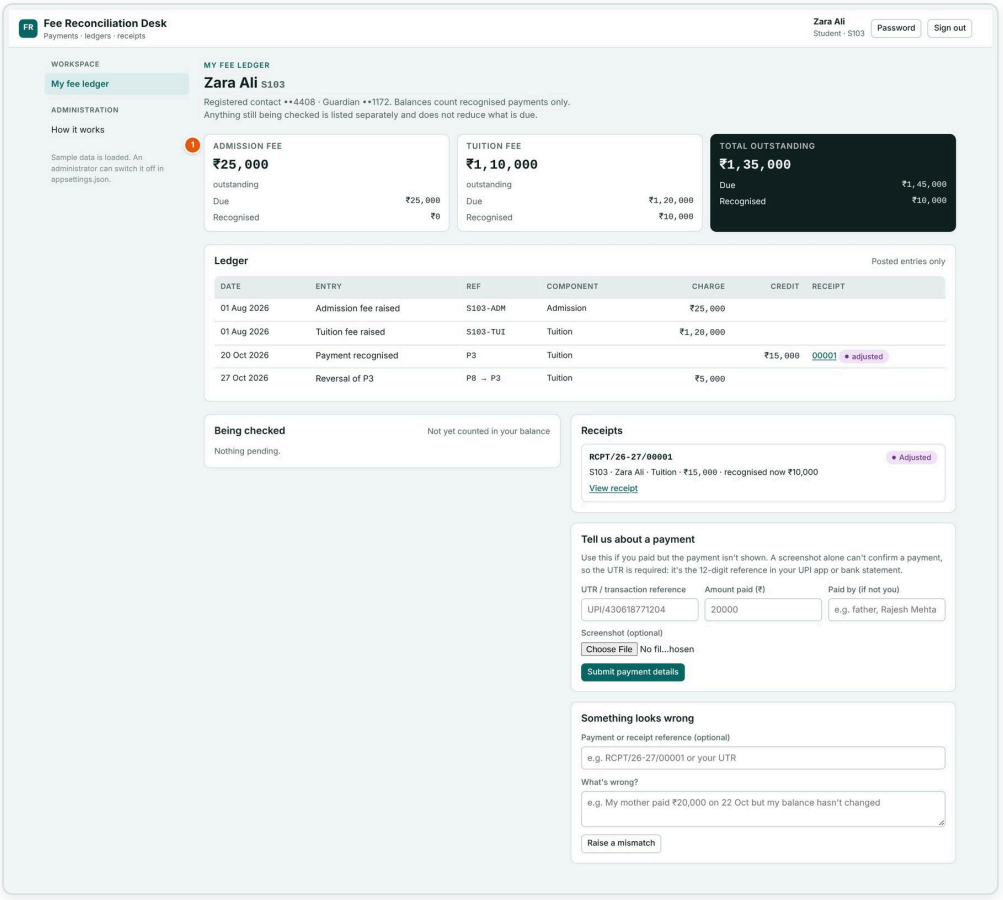


Figure 20: A student's fee ledger after a partial reversal

#	Item	What it does
1	Fee tiles	What is due, what has been recognised and what is still outstanding, for Admission, Tuition and in total

- **Ledger** lists the posted entries: fees raised, payments recognised and reversals. Only payments that are verified, allocated and posted count.
- **Being checked** lists payments you reported that are still under review. They do not reduce what you owe yet.
- **Receipts**: click **View receipt** to see the receipt number, payment reference, amount and any adjustment.

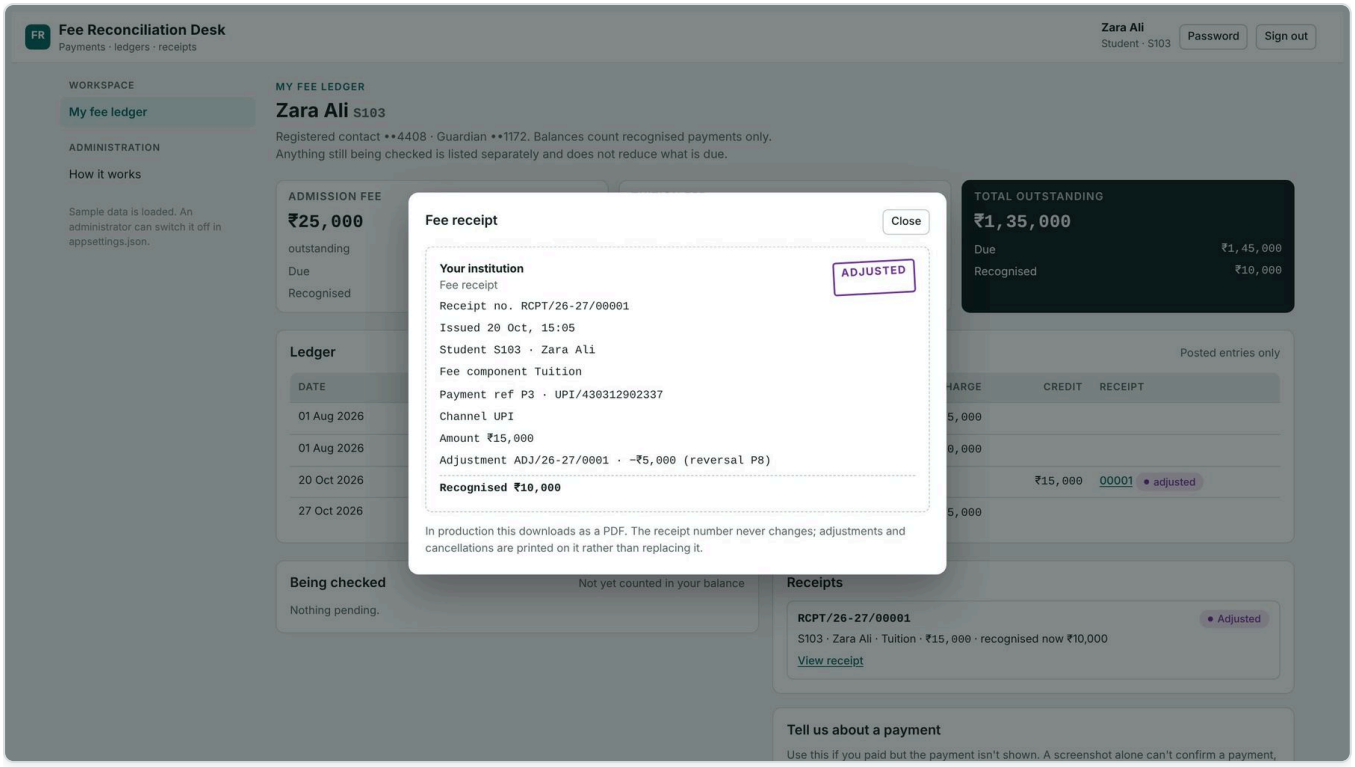


Figure 21: A receipt adjusted by a reversal

10.1 Telling the college about a payment

If you paid but the payment is not shown, fill in **Tell us about a payment**:

1. Enter the UTR or transaction reference from your UPI app or bank statement. It is required.
2. Enter the amount, and who paid if it was not you.
3. Optionally attach a screenshot.
4. Click **Submit payment details**.

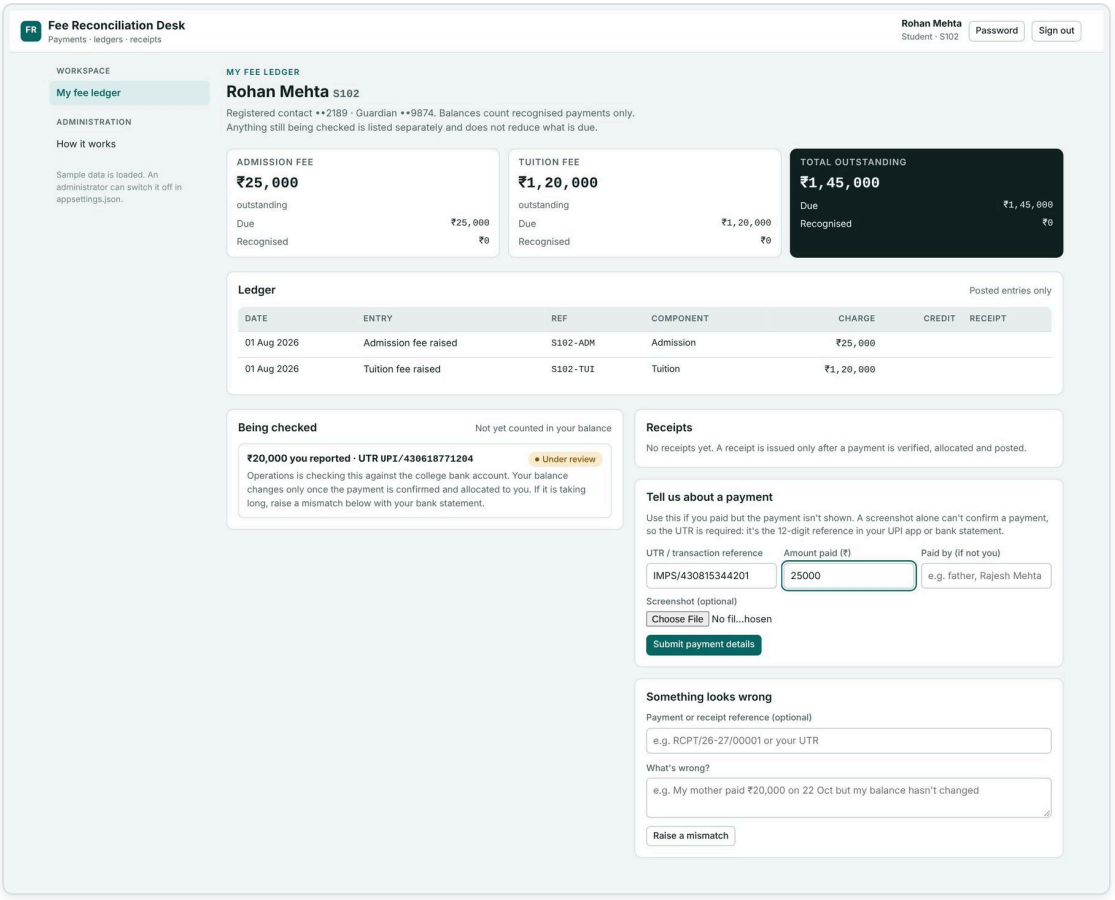


Figure 22: Reporting a payment with its UTR

The payment shows as *Under review* until it is confirmed in the bank statement and allocated to you. A screenshot alone cannot confirm a payment. You can have up to 5 payments under review at a time.

10.2 Raising a mismatch

If something looks wrong, use **Something looks wrong**. Give the payment or receipt reference if you have one, describe the problem, and click **Raise a mismatch**. The reply from Operations appears under **My cases**.

11 Audit log and reports

The **Audit log** (Finance and administrators) records every action, every sign-in and every refused attempt, with the person, role, time, payment and result.

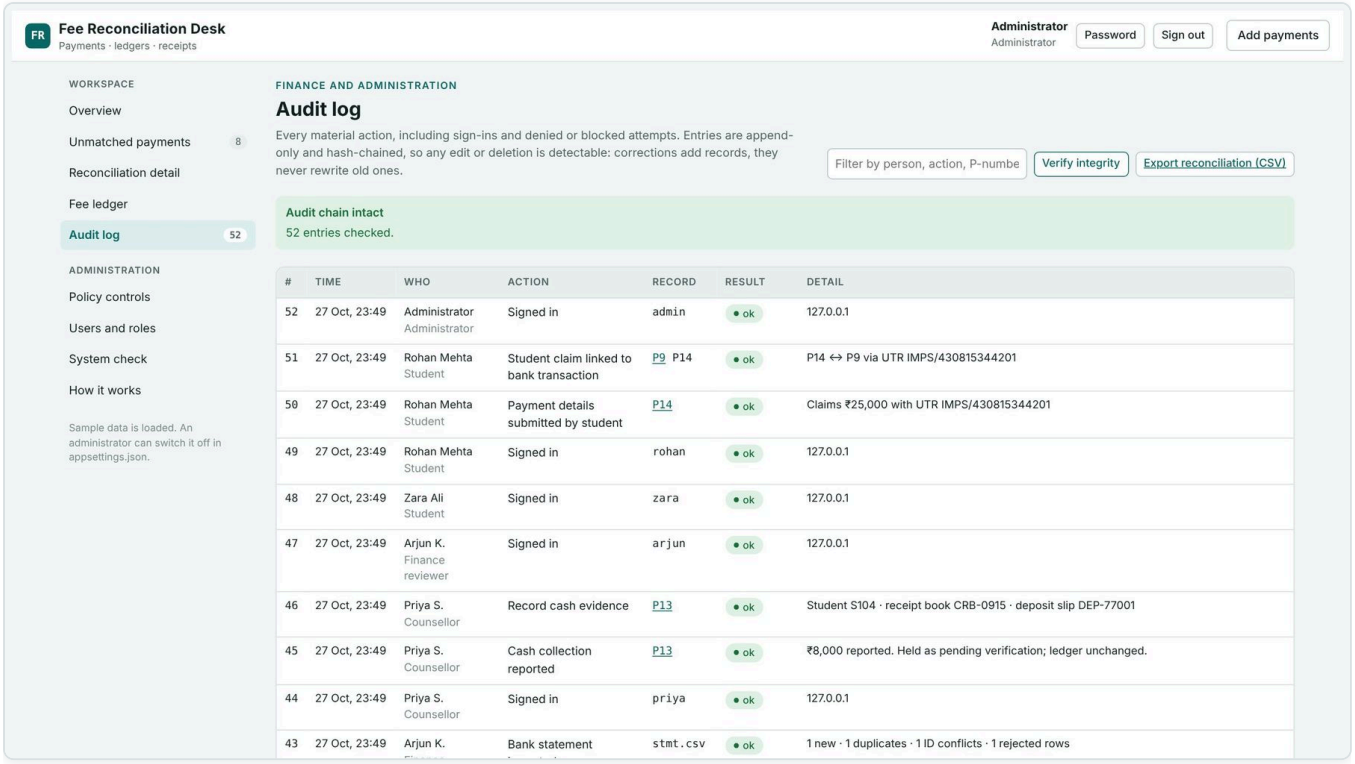


Figure 23: The audit log after the integrity check

- **Verify integrity** recalculates the hash chain. Any edited or deleted entry is detected and named.
- **Export reconciliation (CSV)** downloads one row per payment with its verification, allocations, posted amount and status. The control difference is shown at the foot.

12 Administration

12.1 Policy controls

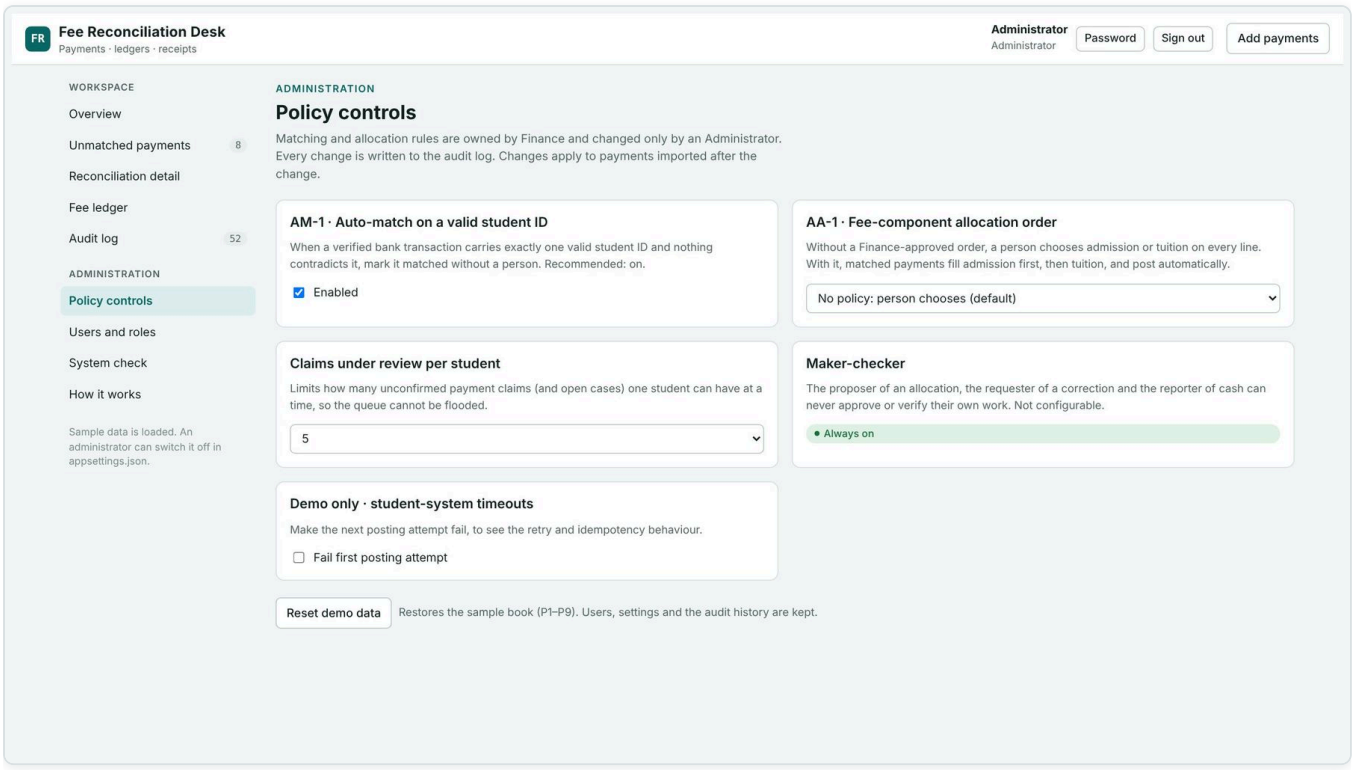


Figure 24: Policy controls (administrators)

Policy	Default	What it means
AM-1 Auto-match on a valid student ID	On	A verified bank line with exactly one valid student ID and no conflicting signal is matched without a person
AA-1 Fee-component allocation order	No policy	With *Admission first, then tuition*, matched payments are allocated and posted automatically. Turn it on only with Finance's written approval.
Claims under review per student	5	Limits unconfirmed claims and open cases per student
Fail first posting attempt	Off	Sample data only: simulates a student-system timeout to show safe retries

Changes take effect for payments imported afterwards and are recorded in the audit log.

12.2 Users and roles

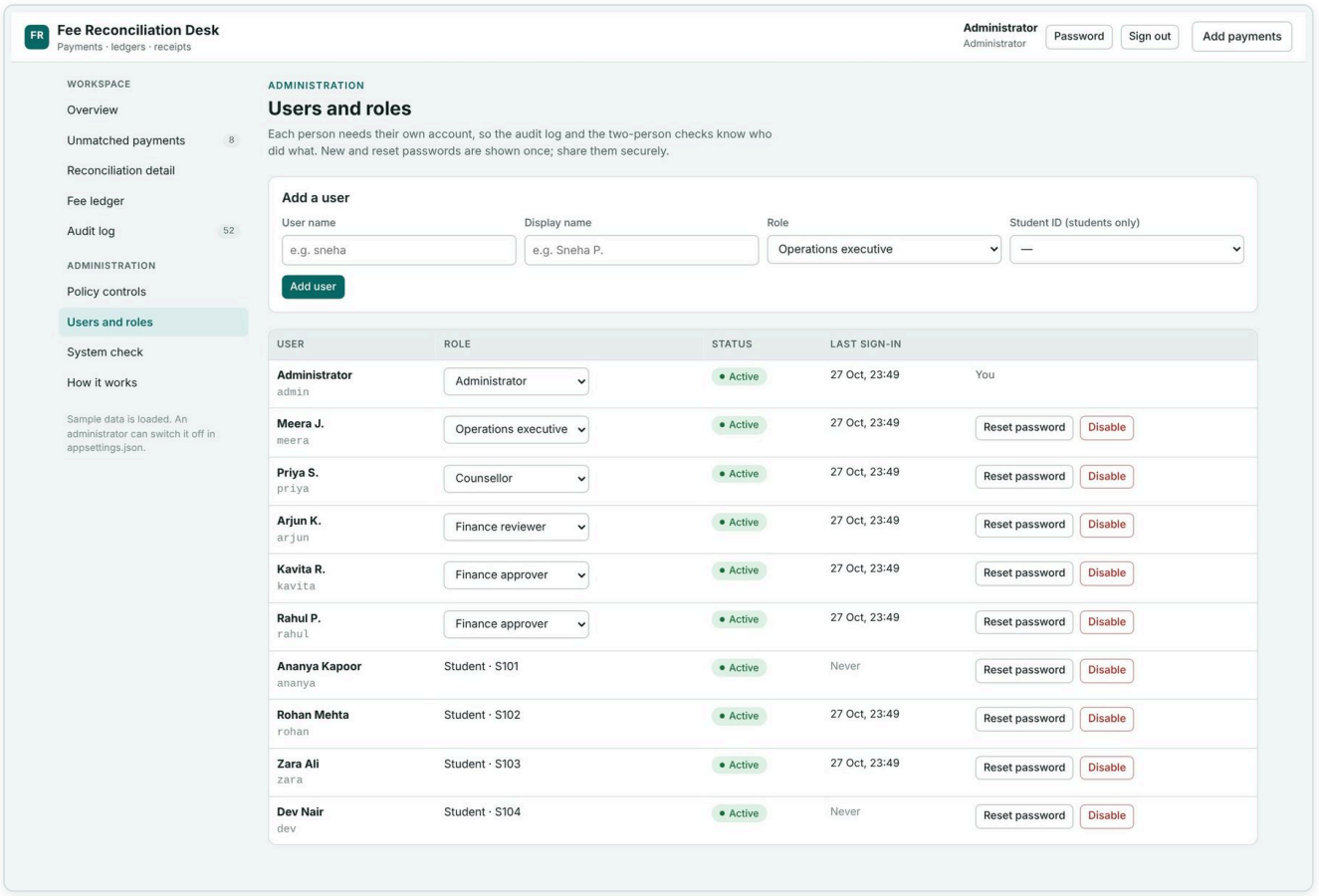


Figure 25: Users and roles

Add one account per person with **Add user**. A temporary password is shown once, so share it securely. In each row you can change the role, **Reset password** or **Disable** the account. Full details are in the Installation and Administration Guide (FRD-IG-02).

12.3 System check

System check (Finance and administrators) runs the 27 built-in scenarios against a fresh copy of the sample data. It never touches live data, and every scenario should pass.

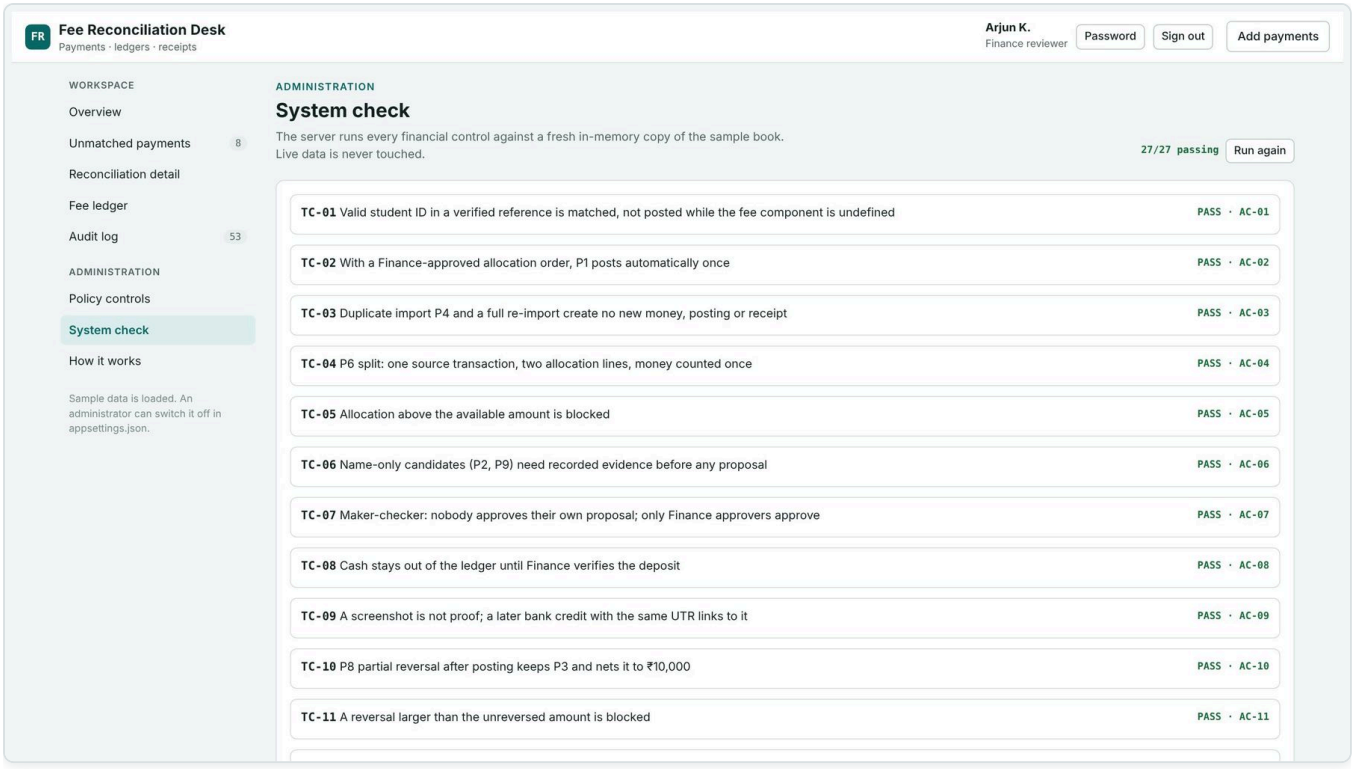


Figure 26: The system check

13 Status reference

Status	Meaning	Who acts
Matched — choose fee component	Student known from a valid ID in the reference; needs Admission or Tuition	Operations
Split — propose lines	The bank remark splits the money across students	Operations
Strong candidate — confirm and allocate	A student claim with the same UTR and amount points to one student	Operations
Candidate — needs evidence	Only a name or phone resembles a student	Operations
Unmatched — no identifier	Nothing links the payment to anyone	Operations
Reference not in student system	The ID in the remark is not registered yet	Operations, after registration
Cash — unverified	Cash reported, no evidence yet	Counsellor
Cash — evidence with Finance	Evidence attached, waiting for verification	Finance reviewer
Claim — not in bank records	A student report with no matching bank line yet	Operations
Waiting on payer	Evidence requested from the payer	Operations
Awaiting approval	A proposal waits for a second person	Finance approver
Posting failed — retry	The student system timed out; nothing was written	Anyone who can retry
Reversal — awaiting approval	A linked bank reversal to apply	Finance approver
Reversal exception	A reversal that cannot be applied as it stands	Finance approver
Same ID, different amount	A repeated bank ID with another amount	Finance reviewer
Duplicate — not posted	A re-imported line, kept for history only	No one
Allocated and posted	Done	No one

Message	What to do
Lines total ₹X but only ₹Y is unallocated	Reduce a line. Part of the money is already proposed or posted.
… has no verified identifier on this payment	Record the corroborating evidence
Separation of duties: … cannot approve it	Ask another Finance approver
This payment changed while you were editing	Another reviewer acted on it. Reload the record, check it and propose again.
Funds changed after this proposal: only ₹X is still free	Reject the proposal and propose again
Security check failed. Reload the page	The page was open across a restart or sign-out. Reload it.
Your session ended	Sign in again. Your role may have changed.

14 Glossary

Term	Meaning
AA-1	The policy that sets an automatic fee-component order. Off by default.
AM-1	The policy that matches on a valid student ID automatically. On by default.
Compensating entry	A ledger entry that cancels an earlier one without deleting it
Hash chain	Each audit entry includes a fingerprint of the one before it, so any change breaks the chain
Idempotent posting	Posting with a unique key, so a repeated request has no further effect
Maker-checker	One person proposes and a different person approves
UTR	Unique Transaction Reference, the bank's ID for a transfer

15 Appendix A: practise with the sample data

The sample data is loaded on first start unless your administrator switched it off. These steps walk through every gate, using the demo accounts listed in FRD-IG-02.

1. As **meera** (Operations), open **P6**, set both lines to *Tuition*, write a reason and click **Propose allocation**.
2. As **kavita** (Finance approver), open P6 and click **Approve and post**. Two receipts are issued.
3. As **kavita**, open **P1**, choose *Admission*, propose it, and see that you cannot approve it. As **rahul**, approve it.
4. As **kavita**, open **P8** and click **Apply reversal**. As **zara** (student S103), see Tuition recognised as ₹10,000 and an adjusted receipt.
5. As **priya** (counsellor), report ₹8,000 cash for S104 and attach the evidence. As **arjun** (Finance reviewer), verify it.
6. As **arjun**, open **Overview** and check that the control difference still reads ₹0.